

Cursor Rules Setup for Code Rot Control

How to place the lecture rules into Cursor and use them operationally

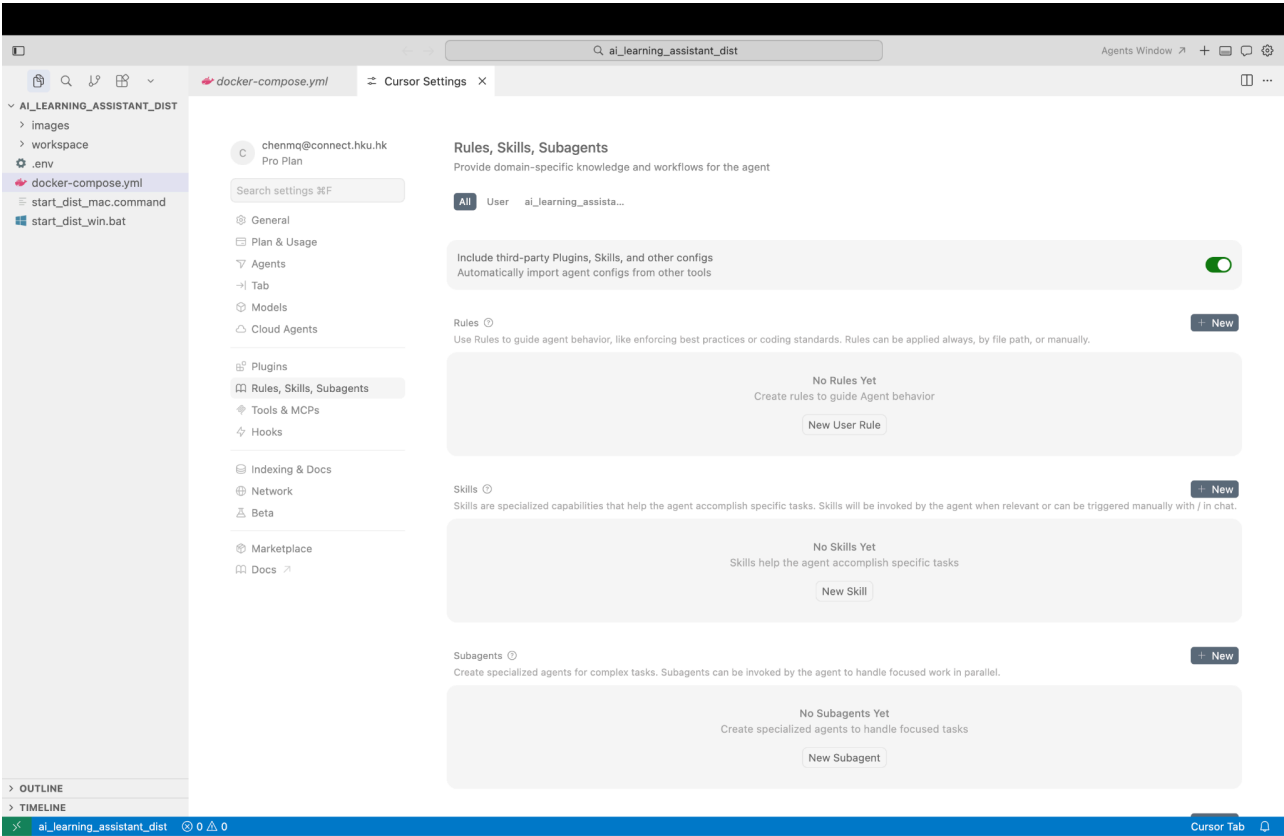
Module 3 • Lecture 3 support document

1. Goal

This document explains how to turn the lecture rules into persistent instructions inside Cursor so that the AI behaves more like a disciplined junior developer under supervision. The main objective is to **slow down code rot and improve project maintainability**.

2. Where to put the rules

- Open Cursor -> Settings -> Rules & Skills -> Rules.



- Use **User / Global Rules for universal working habits** that should apply across projects.
- Use **Project Rules for constraints that belong specifically to the current app, stack, and architecture**.
- Keep the rules short enough to stay readable, but explicit enough to change behavior.

3. Recommended split

Checkpoint	What to confirm
User / Global Rules	Environment-first troubleshooting, explain-before-code behavior, phase discipline, and human-checkpoint discipline.
Project Rules	Tech stack lock, file size / modularity constraints, contract-first rule, and project-specific architecture expectations.

4. Copy-paste block for Rules

Global Rules / User Rules / Project Rules

Common Rules to Block the Rot:

- Tech Stack Lock: "Only use Python for backend. No exceptions."
- Structural Constraint: "No file should exceed 500 lines of code."
- Thinking Protocol: "Always explain the logic before writing the code."

The Contract-First Rule (Web App Focus)

- The Rule: "Always define the Types/Interfaces before writing the logic."